Fruit of Law

Musings on the nature of
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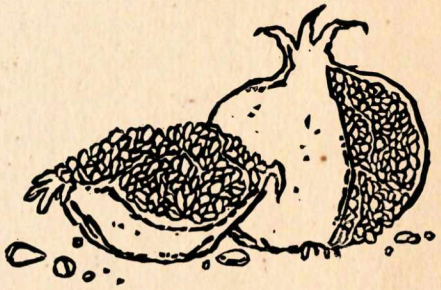

By Eli Seitz

With art by Kit Collins

Inspired by the Talmud

Text and layout by Eli Seitz

Follow him at @seitz_eli on Twitter and on Itchi.io at https://eliseitz.itch.io/

Illustration by Kit Collins

Learn more at www.kitschcollins.com or @kitschcollins on Instagram.

Of the three types of commandments, the decree is the most obtuse. Upon first inspection, it can be difficult to ascertain the purpose of a decree, but this is only true when considered without the context of the whole.

Through a holistic interpretation of the texts, many decrees take on additional significance as the safeguards of laws. In most cases, the law establishes the morality of the issue, but lacks practical application to our lives; its righteness is only possible through separation and distillation.
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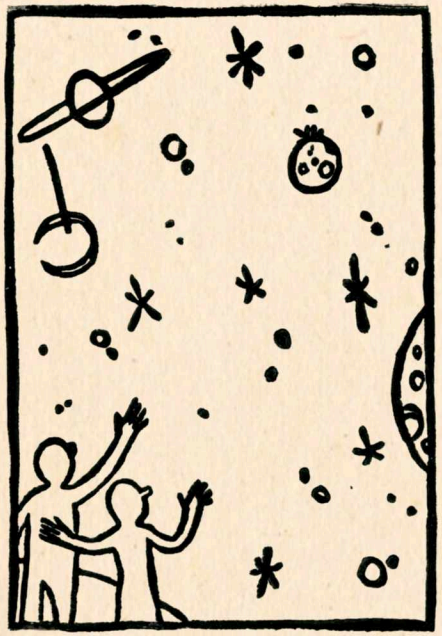
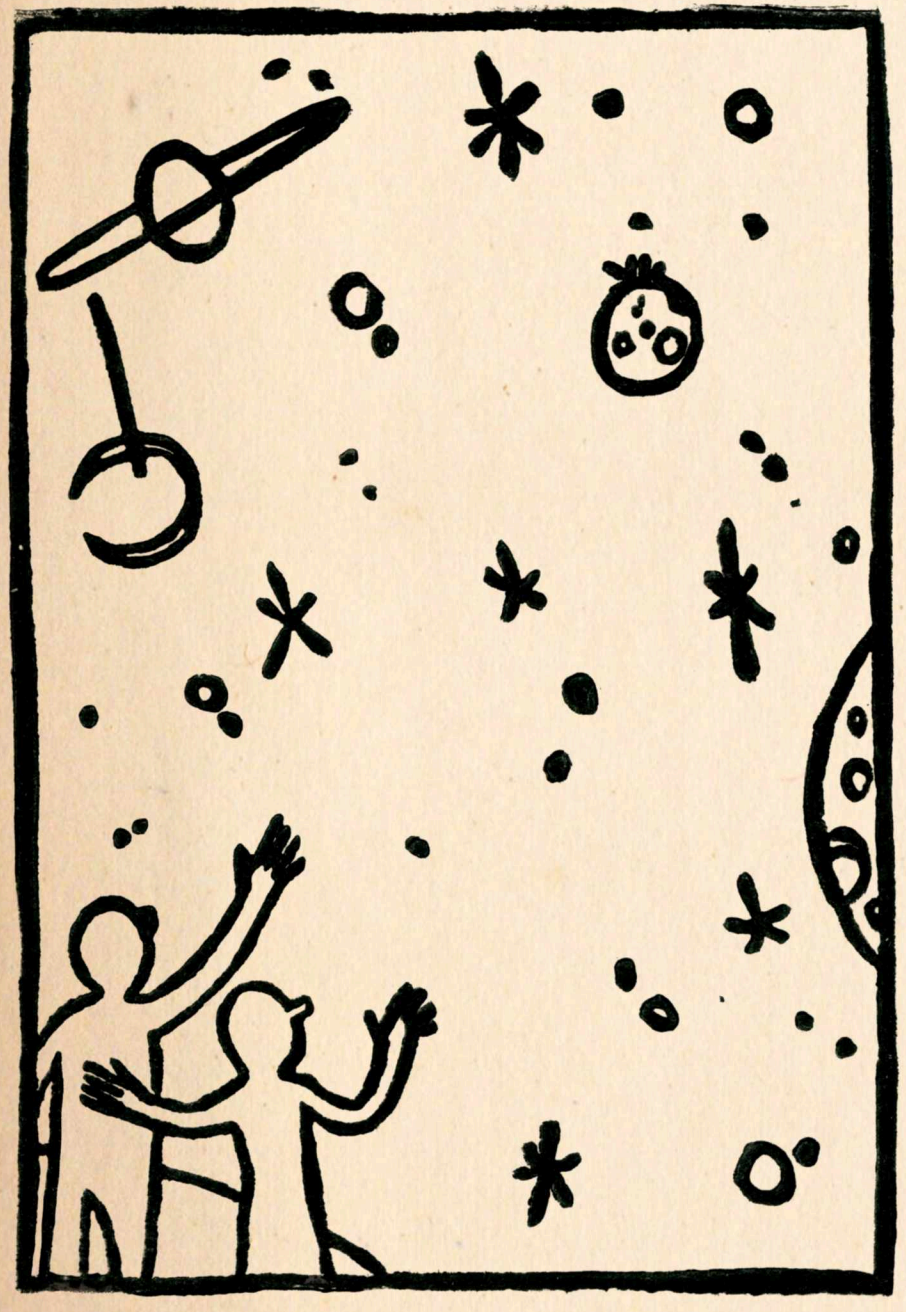
But what can we do to guarantee that the law is followed? Abstractions are hard to enact, so we build fences to protect the laws.

The fences allow us to go beyond the law setting down behaviors and best practices that ensure that the laws we have enshrined are not contested. It is not enough to merely establish the moral ground; we must guide our people in its practice. I will set forth an example to demonstrate my point.

When ☙✶●●ℳ● was on their pilgrimage, they encountered a celebration. Upon seeing ☙✶●●ℳ●, the revelers invited them to the table. In the memory of this story, the elders made the law that all are welcome to celebrations.

After much discussion about the merits and limits of open invitations, elders then passed a decree that it is forbidden to pull the blinds on religious celebrations. The lights must shine bright for all passersby to see. In doing so we ensure that celebrations remain open and cannot be concealed and thus rendered inhospitable.



As you consider each of the 613 grains of truth that exist in the fruit of law, you must retain the image of the whole in your mind. The texts are not a simple list of commands. They are a tapestry, woven together from our experiences. A living document providing guidance to future generations through continual reinterpretation.